

Confidence at Work

Dare to take your place

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

CONTENTS

Confidence at Work

1. Before you begin
2. The 4 approaches
3. Psychodynamic lens
4. CBT lens
5. Humanistic lens
6. Systemic lens
7. Tips & advice
8. Your workbook
9. Your 4-week plan

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Dare to take your place at work

Do you doubt your legitimacy, hold back from speaking up, downplay your wins? Confidence at work isn't an innate trait reserved for others: it's built, gesture by gesture.

This guide helps you understand where your low work-confidence comes from, transform the thoughts that hold you back, and take concrete steps to occupy your place.

Your intention

A work situation where you'd like more confidence: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

The roots of doubt

Low confidence at work rarely comes from your actual skills. It takes root earlier: comparisons, criticism, an environment that made you doubt, or the learned idea that you had to be perfect to have worth.

Understanding this root means no longer mistaking your doubt for a truth about your abilities.

Example

Brilliant at his job, Sami still felt 'not good enough'. Linking the doubt to a very demanding childhood let him detach from it.

Exercise — My history of confidence

Write: when did I start doubting myself at work? · what messages did I get about my worth?

My forgotten wins

List 5 work wins (even small) you downplayed. Re-read them.

→ *My doubt comes from my history — not a real lack of worth.*

The thoughts that hold you back

'I'm not legitimate', 'they'll see I don't know', 'I'm not entitled to ask'. These thoughts make you stay quiet, not apply, not negotiate.

Spotting and softening them reopens what's possible.

Example

Before every meeting, Nadia thought 'I'll say something stupid'. Noting what actually happened, she saw her input was valued.

Work-thought journal

Before a situation that intimidates you, note: the thought · a fairer version.

Reframe the imposter

Turn 'I'm not legitimate' into a thought grounded in facts.

→ *My thoughts aren't facts. My skills are.*

Leaning on your worth

Confidence doesn't come from being perfect, but from accepting yourself with your strengths AND your limits. You have the right to learn, to make mistakes, and to take your place anyway.

Leaning on real strengths is sturdier than chasing perfection.

Example

Instead of waiting to 'master everything', Léa allowed herself to apply with her strengths. She got the job.

Exercise — My work strengths

List 5 strengths you bring to work (skills, relational qualities, reliability...).

My anchor line

A line to tell yourself before a challenge: e.g. 'I belong here, with what I already know.'

→ *I don't have to be perfect to belong.*

Taking acts of confidence

Confidence feeds on action, not waiting. Speaking up, asking, making yourself visible, accepting a challenge: each act, however small, builds confidence — a virtuous circle.

Start small, and let yourself be seen.

Example

Sofia set herself to speak once per meeting. Within a month, her confidence — and her visibility — had changed.

Exercise — My micro-acts

Pick 1 micro-act of confidence per week (speak in a meeting, propose an idea, ask for feedback).

Making myself visible

Note 2 ways to make your work more visible (share a win, take on a project).

→ *Each small act of confidence feeds a bigger one.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Document your wins (a 'wins' file): re-read before an interview or a negotiation.
- Speak up early in meetings: the longer you wait, the harder it gets.
- Stand tall, breathe, slow your pace: the body precedes confidence.
- Ask for concrete feedback instead of imagining what people think.
- Replace 'sorry to bother you' with 'thanks for your time'.
- Aim for 'good enough' over perfect: action beats rumination.

To fill in

Work-thought journal

Date	The situation	The thought	A fairer thought

My wins file

Date	My win	What it says about my strengths

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Understand the source of my doubt.

Week 2 — Spot the thoughts that hold me back.

Week 3 — Lean on my strengths.

Week 4 — Take acts of confidence.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The work situation I'm aiming for:
- My anchor thought:
- My micro-act of confidence:

TO CLOSE

You don't have to wait for your place — you take it.

Step by step. You take your place.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not a substitute for therapy. If you are going through a hard time, please reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.